

If the mundane ever enters into conflict with chimerical qualities, intent and rationalization determine the outcome.

The Importance of Intent

Intent and belief matters in the World of Darkness. It brings structure to unfolding stories, making it possible to understand what's happening before one's eyes.

On her way home, an assassin murders a local troll knight by shooting him in the head with a mundane gun. Due to the disparities between the size of the fae mien and the mortal seeming, it would require the murderer aim above the human head to hit the troll in the forehead. This is not the case. Because the assassin is intent on shooting the victim through the head, the effect manifests that way even chimerically. If the attack is chimerical and the assassin aims directly at the troll's head, mortal witnesses would describe the murderer as aiming for the human's forehead.

Another example of mundane conflicting with chimerical qualities involves trolls walking through doorways. A normal-sized door is smaller than the troll's frame and should force the person to deny her faerie mien in favor of the mundane, but she doesn't have to since the intent is to walk through the door. To faerie eyes, the troll bends ever so slightly, while mortals only see a human walking through the door normally.

Chimera

Chimera are magical treasures, items, clothing, or even sentient creatures created, or born, out of pure Glamour. The child talking to her teddy is, in fact, discussing courtly politics with her chimerical bear companion. In the same way, a beast can walk the streets unburdened by the mundane world and only affected through its chimerical quality.

Fragments of the Dreaming's Heart

Items brimming with so much Glamour that they exist in the Autumn world without a mundane counterpart lack description in faerie vocabulary. Changelings often give the items names and apply of *the Dreaming's Heart* as an epithet. While scholars of magic and chimera among the Kithain have all manner of theories as to what such objects might portend and how best to create or maintain them, most fae accept them at face value for the wondrous items that they are. What makes them remarkable is that they affect the mundane world, and operate on the same principles that conflicts between the chimerical and mundane do.

For example, when the pooka sips away on her tasty soup, using the chimerical-only spoon, her intent is to eat it just like any of the other diners. Onlookers may find her behavior eccentric, but unless they know what to look for, their stifled minds rationalize it, either envisioning a real spoon in her hands, or just glancing away and not thinking about it further. However, if the pooka starts running around, intent on showing everyone her spoon, no one will see it because it has no mundane counterpart.

Kithain History

Much of Kithain history is lost to modern changelings, or at the very least, it is as much myth as fact. Because changelings tend to forget their magical nature as they age, the history of their people is often forgotten as well, and then remembered in bursts during a new incarnation. The most common means of learning about the past, then, is through the traditional art of storytelling. Even with the scarcity of Balefires in modern nights, no freehold turns away a storyteller, for their talents of weaving pre-Shattering tales into life is unmatched by anything an academic historian could present. Long-forgotten acts of villainy and heroism, hope and loss, come to life through their words, leaving audiences captivated with the hope of Arcadia's recovery, and the idea that perhaps *they* are the ones to accomplish this epic undertaking. All it takes is the belief that, despite all pain and horrors that have befallen the Kithain, *theirs* is the story with a happy ending.

Academic History

Despite the thrill and excitement of hearing legends brought to life by storytellers, academic history is an extremely important factor in the pursuit of lost faerie knowledge, turning myth into truth. Many changelings — sluagh especially — lead their lives among vast numbers of tomes and ancient texts, hoping to fulfil their dreams of prestige among their peers, and possibly finding clues to Arcadia in the process. Working with materials predating the Shattering requires a certain type of individual with high endurance and patience.

Ancient texts are written in several, often pictographic, faerie languages, and quite often the words seemingly come alive, constantly realigning, rotating, and shifting locations to avoid being decoded. The Dreaming protects its secrets, but there's no consensus among the Kithain as to why information remains hidden for them as well. Even when enough common denominators exist for a decent decoding, the end results often cause further questions, rather than providing answers.

The latest acquisition by Tara-Nar came from a recently-discovered freehold in the Near Dreaming close to Brittany and, despite studying it for the past decade, they have only managed to successfully translate a single line: "The truce is falling and the Darkening Sky heralds the end of dreams."

The Mythic Age

In the beginning, dark fae ruled everything. Born out of the basal dreams of humanity's primal ancestors, the twisted and malevolent Fomorian strode across the world, wielding the magic of gods through the Dreaming, leaving fear and sadness in their wake. All the lesser creatures bowed before the living shadows, the suffocating winds, and the walking mountains. Fomorian came in all forms and shapes, unified by an appearance instilling horror and obedience in all who witnessed their might.

Humanity toiled away in worship, adapting to their masters' merciless wills, but never receiving anything in return